



**NORTH ATLANTIC MILITARY COMMITTEE
COMITE MILITAIRE DE L'ATLANTIQUE NORD**

NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Leopold III - B-1110 Bruxelles



21 May 2002

MC 343/1 (FINAL)

FINAL DECISION ON MC 343/1

**NATO MILITARY ASSISTANCE TO INTERNATIONAL DISASTER RELIEF
OPERATIONS (IDRO)**

1. On 8 May 02, the North Atlantic Council noted MC 343/1 (Military Decision). Action Sheet to C-M(2002)35 dated 15 May 02 refers.

FOR THE MILITARY COMMITTEE:

SIR PAUL HADDACKS
Vice Admiral, UKNA
Director
International Military Staff

NOTE: This Final Decision Sheet shall now be attached to MC 343 (Military Decision) and MC 343 as the top sheet. Page numbering of the complete document when this decision is attached is as follows:

MC 343/1 (Final)	-	Page i
MC 343/1 (Military Decision)	-	Page 1
MC 343/1 (Enclosure)	-	4 pages

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NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Leopold III - B-1110 Bruxelles



20 March 2002

MC 343/1 (Military Decision)

SECRETARY GENERAL, NORTH ATLANTIC TREATY ORGANISATION

**MILITARY DECISION ON MC 343/1, NATO MILITARY ASSISTANCE TO
INTERNATIONAL DISASTER RELIEF OPERATIONS (IDRO)**

1. On 14 Mar 02, the Military Committee agreed under silence procedure MC343/1, NATO Military Assistance to International Disaster Relief Operations (IDRO), a copy of which is attached at Enclosure 1.
2. MC 343/1 is forwarded by The Military Committee for notation by the North Atlantic Council. Once noted by the Council, MC 343/1 will supersede MC 343(Final), 27 Sep 95.
3. This document clears IMSWM-315-01 and all (SDs).

FOR THE MILITARY COMMITTEE:

SIR PAUL HADDACKS
Vice Admiral, UKNA
Director
International Military Staff

Enclosure

1. MC 343/1

Copy To SDL Z, MILITARY CO-CHAIRMAN SNLC, CIVIL CO-CHAIRMAN SNLC,
CHAIRMAN SCEPC

Action Officer GpCapt P. Miles, LA&R, (5475)

**ENCLOSURE 1 to
MC 343/1 (MILITARY DECISION)**

MC 343/1

**NATO MILITARY ASSISTANCE
TO INTERNATIONAL DISASTER RELIEF OPERATIONS (IDRO)**

References:

- A. AC/305-D/441(Final), 1 Feb1995
- B. C-M(99)21, 29 Apr 99
- C. EAPC (C) D (98) 10(REV), 19 May 1998
- D. PO (2000) 30, REV2, 10 August 2000
- E. PO (2000) 131, 2 Jul 2000
- F. MC 327/2 (FINAL), NATO Military Policy for Non-Article 5 Crisis Response Operations, 1 June 2001
- G. MC 411/1, NATO Military Policy on Civil-Military Co-operation (CIMIC), 17 July 2001
- H. UN-DHA-Geneva, DPR 213/3 MCDA, May 1994

PART I – INTRODUCTION

BACKGROUND

1. During its Spring 1994 Conference, the Senior NATO Logisticians' Conference (SNLC) recognised that the NATO Strategic Concept raised the potential for the use of NATO assets and capabilities, particularly in the area of logistics, in support of humanitarian disaster relief. The SNLC produced a policy paper (Reference A) to serve as the basis for a co-operative relationship between NATO and the United Nations. The Military Committee subsequently adopted the SNLC's document on NATO Military Assistance to IDRO as MC 343. There is a need further to develop policy in this area that reflects the Alliance's 1999 Strategic Concept (Reference B) of pursuing a broad approach to contributing to security and stability in the Euro-Atlantic area in an evolving environment where military means are increasingly requested to assist civil authorities.

2. Recognising the importance of enhanced international co-operation in the field of disaster relief, the Euro-Atlantic Partnership Council (EAPC) in Ministerial session December 1997 endorsed a proposal to create, as a support and complement to the United Nations, a Euro-Atlantic Disaster Response Capability (EADRC). In 1998 the EAPC Ministers agreed to establish an Euro-Atlantic Disaster Response Co-ordination Centre (EADRCC) at NATO Headquarters (Reference C).

3. In July 2000, the North Atlantic Council (NAC) approved the political direction for the reform of NATO Senior Civil Emergency Planning Committee (SCEPC). In the current security environment, five roles for CEP have been identified (Reference D):

- a. Civil Support for Alliance military operations under Article 5;

- b. support for non-Article 5 Crisis Response Operations;
- c. support for national authorities in civil emergencies;
- d. support for national authorities in the protection of populations against the effects of Weapons of Mass Destruction, and
- e. co-operation with Partners.

4. Also in July 2000, the NAC identified the SNLC as the co-ordinating authority for logistics, responsible on behalf of the MC and Council for harmonising and co-ordinating the development of policy recommendations on civil and military logistic matters through consultation and co-operation among nations, the Strategic Commands (SCs) and other logistic and logistic related bodies (Reference E).

5. MC 327/2 (Reference F) provides NATO Military Policy to guide the planning and conduct of NATO non-Article 5 Crisis Response Operations (CRO), including humanitarian emergencies. MC 411/1 (Reference G) addresses civil-military interfaces, including military support for humanitarian emergencies within the context of complex political emergencies when NATO forces are already deployed or to be deployed.

AIM

6. This document sets out the policy for NATO assistance with NATO military owned or controlled assets and capabilities in IDRO. It outlines the principles of military assistance in humanitarian emergencies in case of a disaster relief operation or other civil emergency not connected to any NATO military operation.

PART II – FRAMEWORK OF IDRO

7. The responsibility for effective disaster response rests with a stricken country. However, where the magnitude of the disaster exceeds the national response capability, there may be a need for international assistance. For this reason the United Nations Office for the Co-ordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UN-OCHA) has focused its efforts on the use of Military and Civil Defence Assets (MCDA) in IDRO (Reference H). As a regional initiative, the EADRC complements and provides additional support to the lead UN Agency.

8. The concept of the EADRC has been guided by the following basic principles:
- a. the stricken country remains responsible for disaster management;
 - b. the United Nations retains the primary role in the co-ordination of international disaster relief operations.

Therefore, the EADRCC is intended to complement and provide additional support to the United Nations role within the EAPC area, not to duplicate it. The EADRCC's role within the EAPC is to provide co-ordination rather than direction. In the case of a

disaster requiring international assistance, it will remain for individual nations to decide whether to provide assistance and, if so, whether to do so through the EADRCC or bilaterally directly to the stricken country.

PART III – PRINCIPLES GUIDING NATO MILITARY ASSISTANCE TO IDRO

9. NATO owned or controlled military assets and capabilities include NATO HQs, the Allied Movements Co-ordination Centre (AMCC) and, if and when activated, the SC Logistics Co-ordination Centre (LCC) and the Multinational Joint Logistic Centre (MJLC). The assistance that can be rendered can take the form of logistic, transport, security, communications, information and other support services to national authorities in civil emergencies.

10. If military assistance to IDRO is requested, the principles for NATO providing military assistance should be based on the relevant NAC decisions on providing assistance to humanitarian aid and disaster relief to non-NATO countries. These principles comprise:

a. NATO's immediate military assistance to future IDRO may include any or all of the following:

(1) Assistance and advice by the NMAs to the EADRCC and to the Civil Emergency Crisis Cell, if established on the suitability, use and deployment of NATO-owned or controlled military assets and capabilities in response to requests for disaster relief assistance;

(2) the activation of the LCC in order to provide advice and assistance on the provision of NATO-owned or controlled military assets and capabilities;

(3) the activation of the AMCC, in order to provide advice and assistance on the co-ordination of national military lift capabilities;

(4) consideration on a case-by-case basis of provision of storage capacity, complete with material handling equipment, in suitable NATO infrastructure facilities (in accordance with established Infrastructure Committee procedures); and

(5) the provision, on a case-by-case basis, of staff assistance to UN-OCHA in their planning processes.

b. Military assistance will be provided only on request by an EAPC member nation or by an appropriate international organisation upon decision of the NAC after consultation of the MC:

(1) only on the basis of non-committed NATO capacity;

- (2) on the understanding, that NATO may seek to recover the incremental costs of military involvement in IDRO from the international organisation requesting assistance.

Reflecting non-binding UN-DHA guidelines on the use of military and civil defence assets in disaster relief (Reference H), such assistance will be provided, insofar as is possible, at no cost to the Receiving State unless otherwise agreed between the concerned States and NATO or regulated by international agreements.

c. The provision and deployment of expertise in the form of military personnel employed in NATO international posts will remain a national prerogative, with the IMS available to facilitate such requests.

d. NATO assistance with NATO-owned or controlled military assets and capabilities to IDRO will be exceptional and will not occur without the consultation of the SCs, recommendation by the MC and approval by the NAC.